COUNTRY REPORTS: DRC

STATUS · MATURITY · FINANCE · ONLINE HOSTING

# News, Sep – Oct 2026

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · DATA

## Governance

Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Regional collaboration

### Strategies, plans and policies

TELECOM INFRASTRUCTURE-SHARING AND TAXATION STUDIES UNDER THE CONNECTIVITY PROJECT

- **PACT et telecoms en RDC : baisse des couts en vue** — Numerico.cd, 9 September 2026

  A workshop in Kinshasa on 9 September 2026, under the World Bank-supported connectivity and transport project PACT, presented two studies on the Democratic Republic of Congo's telecoms sector: one on infrastructure sharing, roaming and the .cd domain, the other on taxation. Recommendations include requiring operators to give the regulator current infrastructure data and a central infrastructure database updated twice a year.

### Legislation and regulation

ORDONNANCES-LOIS ORGANISING STATISTICAL ACTIVITY

- **Le Président Tshisekedi fixe les conditions d'organisation de l'activité statistique en RDC - ACP** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 12 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of the Congo's President Félix Tshisekedi signed an ordinance-law organising statistical activity, the 98th Council of Ministers reported on 11 September 2026. It governs the production, dissemination and archiving of official statistics and national censuses, names the Institut national de la statistique as principal statistical authority, and applies its confidentiality rules at once to operations under way.

- **RDC : le gouvernement adopte le projet de loi autorisant la ratification du nouveau cadre de l'activité statistique** — Opinion Info, 12 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's Council of Ministers on 11 September 2026 adopted a bill to ratify the ordinance-law organising official statistics, submitted by the planning minister. The law sets principles of professional independence and statistical confidentiality, and bars use of data collected for statistics for control, prosecution or sanctions outside cases the law provides.

PRIVATE MEMBER'S BILL ON NON-CONSENSUAL DIFFUSION OF INTIMATE CONTENT

- **Violence numérique : une proposition de loi de protection des victimes annoncée à Kinshasa - ACP** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 12 September 2026

  Christelle Vuanga, a member of the Democratic Republic of Congo's National Assembly, announced she will table a bill this parliamentary session amending the penal code and the 2023 digital code to protect victims of non-consensual sharing of intimate images. She proposes prison terms of five to ten years with fines, and heavier penalties where blackmail or minors are involved.

DÉCRET 23/13 CREATING THE SUCCESSOR REGULATOR ARPTIC

- **[Enquête]- ARPTC, un policier illégal et défaillant** — Ouragan.cd, 14 September 2026

  A joint press investigation calls DR Congo's telecoms regulator ARPTC unlawful and ineffective, noting that the successor authority created by a 2023 decree has never been installed. It details failings on service quality and equipment approval.

PRIVATE MEMBER'S BILL ON THE PROTECTION OF MINORS IN THE DIGITAL ENVIRONMENT

- **Assemblée nationale: le député Alfred Dibandi initie une proposition de loi relative à la protection des mineurs dans l'environnement numérique** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026

  Alfred Dibandi Nzondomyo, a national deputy in the Democratic Republic of Congo, filed a private member's bill on protecting minors in the digital environment on 21 September 2026. He said it complements the Digital Code and child-protection law, with rules by age band for under-6s, under-11s and under-15s. The bill's text has not been published.

BILL AMENDING THE CODE DU NUMÉRIQUE ON MINORS' ACCESS TO SOCIAL PLATFORMS

- **DRC Senate Considers Social Media Ban for Children Under 13** — We Are Tech, 1 October 2026

  The DR Congo Senate declared admissible on 28 September 2026 a bill by Senator Yvan Kazadi Kankonde amending the 2023 Digital Code to bar children under 13 from opening social media accounts. Those aged 13 to 15 would need verifiable parental consent, and platforms would have to verify age. The bill has gone to committee and is not law.

### Regional collaboration

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA MADAGASCAR MAURITIUS RWANDA TUNISIA GLOBAL

  Angola, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda and Tunisia are among the 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration on space-based scientific data published by France's presidency on 10 September 2026. It commits signatories to open access to satellite observation data, save for exceptions such as security and personal data, and to common exchange standards.

## Finance

MoUs and other agreements · New investments

### MoUs and other agreements

DIGITAL AND PAYMENTS PROGRAMME FOR THE KINSHASA EXPANSION PROJECT

- **Algerian Company INATEL Signs Strategic Agreement for New Kinshasa City Project** — Africa News (DZ), 3 September 2026

  Algeria's state electronics firm INATEL, in a consortium with PGS Africa and DABYAN, signed a memorandum with the committee overseeing the Kinshasa city expansion project in the DR Congo to deploy payment systems, digital equipment and a technology centre covering cybersecurity and applied AI. The signing date is given only as recent, and no value or timetable is disclosed.

- **Inatel signe un accord strategique pour le projet de nouvelle ville de Kinshasa** — Algerie Eco, 4 September 2026 ALGERIA

> The Algerian state electronics firm INATEL, with PGS Africa and DABYAN, signed a protocol with the coordination of the DRC's Kinshasa expansion project for an integrated digital, industrial and technological programme covering digital technologies, electronic payment systems, digital equipment and services, knowledge transfer and a centre for innovation in payment systems, cybersecurity and applied artificial intelligence. No amount is stated.

### New investments

> VODACOM CONGO NETWORK INVESTMENT PROGRAMME

- **RDC : Vodacom veut porter à 670 millions USD ses investissements réseau pour accélérer la transformation numérique** — Zoom Eco, 9 October 2026

  Vodacom Congo said at a Kinshasa forum on 8 October 2026 that it plans a long-term US$670 million network investment programme, against an average of US$140 million a year. It reported 26.4 million subscribers, 4G coverage of 46.1 per cent and 10 million M-Pesa customers. Prime Minister Judith Suminwa said state and citizens' data must be hosted in the country.

## ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity · Energy · Technical Capacity

### Connectivity

> INDEPENDENT TOWER ESTATE

- **RDC : plus de 40 millions de Congolais connectés grâce aux infrastructures de Helios Towers** — ACTUALITE.CD, 4 September 2026

  Helios Towers RDC said on 3 September 2026 that it now operates 3,000 telecoms sites in the Democratic Republic of Congo, 673 of them in rural areas, and that its infrastructure supports mobile coverage for more than 40 million people. The milestone marks the company's fifteenth year in the country. The figures come from a company release carried by the paper.

> KIGOMA-KALEMIE FIBRE ACROSS LAKE TANGANYIKA

- **Tanzania, DRC agree to fast-track SGR link and fibre-optic cable across Lake Tanganyika** — Daily News (Tanzania), 5 September 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania and the DRC agreed to fast-track a fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie across Lake Tanganyika, alongside a standard gauge railway link through Burundi and the establishment of a joint economic commission. The commitment was reaffirmed at a farewell meeting for the Congolese ambassador; no route survey, cost, financing or delivery date is published.

> GOMA-MOMBASA FIBRE ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 RWANDA UGANDA KENYA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

> INTERNET SERVICE QUALITY IN KINSHASA AND THE REGULATOR'S RESPONSE

- **Connexion Internet à Kinshasa : les consommateurs à bout, les opérateurs interpellés, l'ARPTC sous pression** — Forum des As, 17 September 2026

  Internet subscribers in Kinshasa report slow speeds, frequent interruptions and difficulty reaching online services across all four mobile operators, against the packages they pay for. The regulator is being called on to act.

NATIONAL DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION PROJECT FIBRE BACKBONE

- **DR Congo plans four 20-year PPPs for 11,600km fibre network** — The PPP Post, 26 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo plans to extend its fibre-optic backbone by 11,600 km through four 20-year concessions tendered internationally, with gap financing for routes whose revenues cannot cover the cost, reported on 26 September 2026. Expressions of interest for the supervision consultancy close on 14 October 2026, for work from June 2027.

HELIOS TOWERS AND UNICEF SCHOOL-CONNECTIVITY PARTNERSHIP (GIGA)

- **Helios Towers partners with UNICEF to accelerate digital inclusion and expand learning opportunities for children across Africa** — UNICEF UK, 28 September 2026 MALAWI TANZANIA

  Helios Towers and UNICEF announced a multi-year partnership on 28 September 2026 supporting UNICEF's Giga school-connectivity initiative and its Learning Passport digital-learning programme, starting in the Democratic Republic of Congo, Malawi and Tanzania. Helios Towers will support school connectivity mapping and infrastructure. No funding figure is given.

5G COMMERCIAL LAUNCH

- **RDC : le gouvernement annonce le lancement commercial de la 5G** — 7sur7.cd, 11 October 2026

  DR Congo's posts and telecommunications minister presented the commercial launch of 5G to the Council of Ministers on 9 October, as a new source of state revenue and a way to improve service quality. Deployment is to begin in urban areas; no operator, spectrum assignment or launch date was given.

- **RDC : la 5G en préparation, près de 7 Congolais sur 10 restent hors ligne** — wearetech.africa, 12 October 2026

  DR Congo's government is preparing a commercial 5G launch, which the telecommunications minister said in late September it was working to make available before the end of 2026. The article sets that against internet use of about 30.5% of the population at the end of 2025 and mobile internet coverage of 45%.

FIBRE INTERCONNECTION WITH THE CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC

- **Internet : qu'est-ce que la liaison par fibre avec la RDC peut apporter à la Centrafrique** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026 CAR

  The digital-economy ministers of the Central African Republic and DR Congo agreed in Moscow on 8 October on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection between the two countries, which would give the Central African Republic a third international route, toward the submarine cable landing at Moanda. No timetable or financing was announced.

TELECOMMUNICATIONS CUT IN FIZI TERRITORY AND BARAKA, SOUTH KIVU

- **Sud-Kivu : la société civile exige la réouverture des réseaux de télécommunications coupés depuis 3 mois** — CongoRassure, 13 October 2026

Civil society in Fizi territory and Baraka, South Kivu, published a memorandum to the President demanding the reopening of telecommunications networks it says have been cut since 3 July 2026. It alleges that soldiers seized satellite kits and phones and that local authorities resold satellite Wi-Fi, and announces a sit-in from 19 October.

### Energy

EMERGENT GRID COMPUTE-ANCHORED MINI-GRID DEMONSTRATION

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026
  KENYA · SIERRA LEONE · AFRICA

  The Rockefeller Foundation's Mission 300 Accelerator announced the Emergent Grid Project on 24 September 2026, testing whether AI computing placed at African mini-grids can act as an anchor customer and improve their finances. The first sites are five in Kenya, a solar plant in DR Congo and three in Sierra Leone, serving about 85,000 people, with local electricity demand given priority over computing. No amount is stated.

### Technical Capacity

DIGITAL EQUIPMENT ASSEMBLY AND PRODUCTION FACILITY AT MALUKU

- **Kinshasa Kia Mona Plans Digital Equipment Assembly Facility** — BANKABLE, 3 September 2026

  The DR Congo office coordinating the Kinshasa Kia Mona city expansion signed a memorandum on 30 August 2026 with the PGS Africa-INATEL-DABYAN consortium for a plant at Maluku to assemble payment terminals, ATMs and computers. An innovation centre and vocational training are included. The memorandum states no investment figure, production capacity or construction timetable.

IMPLEMENTATION CAPACITY OF THE DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION PROJECT

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA · MALAWI · ZAMBIA · ESWATINI · EAST AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA

  COMESA's half-year progress report on the World Bank-financed Inclusive Digitalisation in Eastern and Southern Africa programme, a US$2.48 billion envelope, covers January to June 2026 in Angola, the DRC, Malawi, Zambia and Eswatini. The COMESA secretariat had spent 9% of its US$3.71 million 2026 budget by June, and moved its AI and regional digital inclusion consultancies from procurement to implementation.

- **Transformation numérique : le COPIL valide le PTBA 2026 et appelle à accélérer l'exécution du projet** — 7sur7.cd, 10 October 2026

  The steering committee of the DRC's digital transformation project met for the first time on 8 October and approved the 2026 work plan and budget. Members went through delays component by component and set priorities to 2027.

## DPI

Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

### Data Exchange

REVENUE-AGENCY DATA CROSS-CHECKING UNDER SYSTEMIC CONTROL

- **RDC : les recettes mensuelles de la TVA passent de 123,7 à plus de 141,4 millions $ grâce aux réformes fiscales (Doudou Fwamba)** — 7sur7.cd, 3 September 2026

  The DRC's finance minister, Doudou Fwamba, said on 3 September 2026 that monthly VAT receipts rose from an average of FC280bn to above FC320bn after VAT e-filing and standardised invoices were introduced. A data warehouse linking the three revenue agencies holds data from two of them, and he put funding for the Huawei-backed E-Finance programme at over US$150m.

NATIONAL ELECTRONIC CERTIFICATION AUTHORITY

- **RDC : stratégies, identité numérique et cybersécurité au bilan d'un an de réformes** — Agence Ecofin, 30 September 2026

  The DRC's digital economy minister said the prime minister had signed decrees creating an online administrative-services portal and a national electronic certification agency, and that a national cybersecurity agency had been created by presidential ordinance. He said the RDC-PASS digital identity entered a first operational phase in September with 50 enrolment agents trained.

NATIONAL HEALTH DATA PLATFORM AND ITS INTEGRATIONS

- **Africa CDC Deploys Digital Tools, CHEWs To Strengthen Ebola Response In DRC** — Science Nigeria, 2 October 2026

  Africa CDC said more than 150 internet devices, including Starlink systems, have been deployed to Ebola-affected health zones in the Democratic Republic of Congo to replace paper-based reporting, with 142 more due within two weeks and 600 being procured. Outbreak data run on DHIS2, and a second response plan mobilises 71,000 community health workers.

### Digital Identity and CRVS

BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Semlex to face criminal trial in Belgium over Congo passport scandal** — Biometric Update, 1 September 2026

  Fourteen defendants in the case of Semlex, the Belgian firm that made the Democratic Republic of Congo's biometric passports from 2015 to 2025, have been sent to a Brussels criminal court on bribery, money laundering and tax fraud charges. Investigators allege about $60 of each $185 passport went to a Dubai firm, nearly $60 million in all; 51 Congolese citizens are civil parties.

- **RDC: Jean-Claude Mputu dénonce la continuité Semlex-RAM** — CongoQuotidien, 2 September 2026

  Jean-Claude Mputu, spokesman for the Congo Is Not For Sale coalition (CNPAV), said the Democratic Republic of Congo's passport contract with Semlex, renewed in 2020 when the original five-year deal expired, has never been published. The renewal, meant to last a year, ran until 2025; the only concession won was a passport price cut from $185 to $100.

DIASPORA DIGITAL IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **RDC : Haut Conseil, carte Okapi et identification numérique…Crispin Mbadu détaille les réformes en faveur de la diaspora** — 7sur7.cd, 12 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's minister delegate for the diaspora, Crispin Mbadu Phanzu, said in a first-year review reported on 12 September 2026 that his ministry has introduced the OKAPI card for Congolese by origin who took another nationality, and is developing a digital identification system for the diaspora. No launch date, issuing body or enrolment figure is given.

- **Diaspora congolaise : lancement à Paris et Bruxelles de la phase pilote de l'identification numérique** — B-one télévision, 30 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's minister delegate for the diaspora, Crispin Mbadu Phanzu, launched a pilot of digital identification for Congolese abroad at the embassy in Paris on 27 September 2026, and presented the registration platform diaspora.gouv.cd in Brussels two days later. Registrants record their education, specialisms and intended contributions. Extension to other missions is planned, with no dates given.

NATIONAL POPULATION IDENTIFICATION OPERATION

- **RDC : l'identification de la population annoncée pour la mi-décembre 2026** — Opinion Info, 12 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of the Congo plans to start national population identification in mid-December 2026, the 98th Council of Ministers heard from interior minister Jacquemain Shabani. The national population identification office, ONIP, will run the operation. The government said funding expected from partners and ONIP's own capacity could affect the timetable. No cost is given.

- **RDC : ce qu'il faut retenir de l'identification de la population et du recensement général de la population** — Beto.cd, 13 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's Council of Ministers, in a report read on 11 September 2026, set mass identification by the identity office ONIP to begin in December 2026 and the second general census to be enumerated in 2027. The two exercises fall under different ministries and budgets. The data protection authority has not yet been installed.

OKAPI CARD FOR CONGOLESE BY ORIGIN HOLDING ANOTHER NATIONALITY

- **RDC : Haut Conseil, carte Okapi et identification numérique…Crispin Mbadu détaille les réformes en faveur de la diaspora** — 7sur7.cd, 12 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

RDC-PASS NATIONAL DIGITAL IDENTITY PLATFORM

- **RDC : plus de 9 000 candidats pour RDC Pass** — Digital Business Africa, 14 September 2026

  DR Congo's digital economy ministry said more than 9,000 candidates sat the recruitment test for RDC Pass agents and a first cohort of 50 was retained for the Kinshasa pilot. Training starts on 15 September, followed by extension to other Kinshasa zones and then nationwide.

- **RDC-Pass : lancement de la formation des 50 premiers agents d'enregistrement** — 7sur7.cd, 16 September 2026

  DR Congo began training the first 50 enrolment agents for its RDC-Pass digital identity platform on 15 September 2026, three months after its launch. The digital economy minister said RDC-Pass is an authentication tool, not a national identity card, and does not replace civil registration.

- **RDC : le projet d'identification numérique RDC-Pass entre dans sa phase opérationnelle** — wearetech.africa, 17 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's RDC-Pass digital identity project entered its first implementation phase three months after launch, with training for 50 registration agents opening in Kinshasa on 15 September. The identifier is intended to work across several administrations and reduce the number of separate identification systems.

POPULATION IDENTIFICATION ROADMAP

- **RDC : l'ONIP réaffirme son engagement en faveur d'un système national sécurisé d'identification** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 17 September 2026

  DR Congo's national population identification office (ONIP) said on International Identity Day, 16 September 2026, that preparations for the national identification system are complete and data collection will start in December 2026, as a step towards a general population register. It said data security, privacy and transparency must be guaranteed as identification systems become interconnected.

### Digital Payments and Fintech

ROADMAP FOR MODERNISING THE NATIONAL PAYMENTS SYSTEM

- **Le pari de la Banque centrale pour moderniser le système de paiements** — Ouragan, 4 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Congo instructed its technical services to draw up a roadmap for modernising the national payments system, its governor said after a central bank payments conference in Istanbul. The stated aims are the security, fluidity and continuity of transactions and assessing the uses and risks of artificial intelligence, tokenisation, stablecoins and central bank digital currencies; the delegation gave sustained attention to offline payment, given electricity and internet constraints in several parts of the country.

ISYS-REGIES REVENUE COLLECTION PLATFORM

- **Presumee cyber-maffia a la Banque Centrale sur les recettes de la DGI : versions croisees** — Congo Guardian, 10 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's tax directorate wrote to the finance minister on 3 September 2026 alleging that central bank staff siphoned tax revenue by manipulating the ISYS-REGIES revenue platform, and sought their suspension and a judicial inquiry. On 10 September the Banque Centrale du Congo denied it, saying every action on the platform is logged and cannot be altered after validation.

- **RDC : la BCC dement toute manipulation des recettes de l'Etat et clarifie les ecarts entre Isys-regies et Navision** — Actualite.cd, 11 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Congo denied on 10 September 2026 that state revenue had been deleted or altered in ISYS-RÉGIES, its revenue-collection platform built since 2021 with the French development agency AFD. It said gaps against its NAVISION accounting system mostly involve the savings bank CADECO, which is outside its clearing house, and are settled in a monthly reconciliation. AFD and the finance ministry signed a €12.5 million convention in 2021 to digitise and link the revenue agencies.

MICROFINANCE TRANSITION TO DIGITAL PAYMENTS

- **DRC Microfinance Institutions Seek Digital Support Ahead of Dollar Cash Ban** — BANKABLE, 14 September 2026

  Microfinance institutions in the Democratic Republic of Congo are seeking financial and technical support to move to digital payments before the central bank's ban on US dollar cash transactions takes effect on 9 April 2027. An August 2026 report by the microfinance and savings cooperative associations, ANIMF and APROCEC, with Innogence Consulting, names the deadline as a main constraint for smaller institutions.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (PAPSS) ACCESSION

- **EAC, PAPSS, IA : la BCC accélère l'intégration de la RDC dans l'écosystème financier africain** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026

DR Congo joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System on 18 September 2026, when the central bank governor, André Wameso, signed the accession agreement in Nairobi. The same day he signed the East African Community central banks' memorandum on currency convertibility and repatriation, which Burundi, Uganda, Tanzania, Kenya and South Sudan had already joined.

NATIONAL CONSUMER COMPLAINTS PLATFORM

- **Communiqué de presse N°163/2026 : le Ministère de l'Économie Nationale lance « LOBA », une plateforme numérique dédiée à la protection des consommateurs** — Ministère de l'Économie Nationale (RDC), Cellule de communication, 5 October 2026

  The Democratic Republic of the Congo's Ministry of National Economy launched LOBA, a national consumer-protection platform, from 6 October 2026. Run through the Competition Commission (COMCO) with sector regulators covering telecoms, banking, insurance, electricity and health, it lets consumers report abuses, learn their rights and track complaints via a WhatsApp chatbot and a mobile app.

### Registries

NATIONAL QR-CODE PRODUCT TRACEABILITY AND CERTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **DRC to Roll Out QR Code System to Track Products and Fight Counterfeits** — We are Tech (wearetech.africa), 7 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of the Congo's standards control office plans a national QR-code system letting consumers scan a product — medicines included — to verify its certification status, with consumer checks stated as opening within weeks and resting on 88 laboratories across 29 sites. No launch date, register or enforcement route is published.

SINGLE UNIQUE IDENTIFIER FOR BUSINESSES

- **RDC : Félix Tshisekedi veut instaurer un identifiant numérique unique pour les entreprises** — numerico.cd, 29 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's President Félix Tshisekedi gave the government three months, at the Council of Ministers on 25 September 2026, to set up a single identifier for businesses recognised by all public administrations. The plan relies on interoperable public information systems and harmonised legal texts, and a report on the mechanism and timetable is due within the three months.

LOI 25-062 ON THE LAND AND PROPERTY REGIME

- **RDC : l'apport de la digitalisation du secteur foncier présenté à Kinshasa** — ACP, 8 October 2026

  The DRC's land affairs minister said implementation of the December 2025 land law has begun: digitisation directorates created and more than 350 officials trained in archiving. Three of Kinshasa's nine land districts are in the first phase, toward a geolocated digital cadastre.

### Sectoral management information systems

ANONYMISED MOBILE-PHONE DATA IN OUTBREAK RESPONSE

- **Health officials turn to mobile-phone data to track Ebola spread in Congo** — Reuters, 3 September 2026

  The World Health Organization and the non-profit Flowminder are using anonymised Vodacom mobile-phone records to map population movement and predict where the Democratic Republic of Congo's Ebola outbreak will spread, the first such use in an Ebola response, Reuters reported on 3 September 2026. The data flagged Kisangani as at risk before cases appeared there. The outbreak has infected more than 6,250 people and killed 3,039.

FACTURE NORMALISÉE (STANDARDISED VAT E-INVOICING SYSTEM)

- **RDC : les recettes mensuelles de la TVA passent de 123,7 à plus de 141,4 millions $ grâce aux réformes fiscales (Doudou Fwamba)** — 7sur7.cd, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

- **RDC/Impôt : la DGI déploie un contrôle rigoureux de la facture normalisée après la fin du moratoire** — Magazine RD CONGO-MONDE, 9 October 2026

  The DRC's tax directorate began nationwide checks of the standardised invoice on 5 October, after the moratorium ended. Consumers are asked to verify invoices by QR code in the official application, with rewards for verified reports of non-compliance.

FINANCE INSPECTORATE'S NATIONAL FINANCIAL-DATA HUB

- **Digitalisation en RDC : l'IGF lance le recrutement d'un cabinet pour son Hub national de données financières - Scoop RDC** — Scoop RDC, 14 October 2026

  DR Congo's Inspection Générale des Finances is recruiting a firm to design and deploy a national financial-data hub, a central warehouse pulling data from several systems for control, audit and investigation work. The twelve-month assignment sits under the IGF's 2026-2028 digitalisation plan and includes staff training; applications close on 30 October 2026.

### Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYGREM MULTIMODAL FREIGHT-CHARGE MANAGEMENT PLATFORM

- **Lancement officiel de la plateforme SYGREM par le VPM Jean Pierre Bemba fruit du partenariat entre l'OGEFREM et PADS Corporation** — Ministere des Transports RDC, 2 September 2026

  DR Congo's transport minister Jean-Pierre Bemba launched SYGREM, a freight-charge management platform built by the freight office Ogefrem with PADS Corporation, in Kinshasa on 1 September 2026. It digitises the FERI, AD and FERE freight-tracking documents and adds geolocation and online payment, with receipts paid into dedicated Ogefrem bank accounts.

E-FINANCE DIGITAL PUBLIC-FINANCE PROGRAMME

- **RDC : les recettes mensuelles de la TVA passent de 123,7 à plus de 141,4 millions $ grâce aux réformes fiscales (Doudou Fwamba)** — 7sur7.cd, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

GUICHET UNIQUE INTEGRAL DU COMMERCE EXTERIEUR (GUICE)

- **RDC : Julien Paluku vante la dématérialisation des procédures commerciales pour lutter contre la corruption** — DeskNews, 17 September 2026

  DR Congo's foreign trade minister Julien Paluku Kahongya told the WTO Public Forum in Geneva on 17 September 2026 that 93 of the 98 documents needed for foreign trade have been digitised, with the rest due by end-2026. He said the foreign-trade single window is now linked to the customs authority's SYDONIA World system.

- **SEGUCE RDC poursuit le deploiement du GUICE et rapproche les services du commerce exterieur des operateurs economiques du Kasai Oriental** — ACTUALITE.CD, 17 September 2026

The concessionaire running DR Congo's integrated foreign-trade single window took it to Mbuji-Mayi in Kasai Oriental, presenting its services to provincial authorities, the administrations concerned and local traders and hearing their concerns. Its director general framed provincial establishment as territorial equity, the window being a national instrument.

GUICHET NUMÉRIQUE (ONLINE ADMINISTRATIVE SERVICES WINDOW)

- **RDC : stratégies, identité numérique et cybersécurité au bilan d'un an de réformes** — Agence Ecofin, 30 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

ELECTORAL COMMISSION ELECTRONIC DOCUMENT MANAGEMENT

- **CENI : Denis Kadima lance la numérisation des archives et la formation de 762 cadres et agents** — Dépêche.cd, 1 October 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's electoral commission, CENI, launched a programme in Kinshasa on 28 September 2026 to digitise electoral archives produced since 2005 into a single secure document repository. Its president, Denis Kadima, also launched training in four phases for 762 staff, including AI applied to elections. No cost or funder is stated.

INTEGRATED ELECTRONIC-VISA PLATFORM

- **RDC : Kinshasa accélère la mise en œuvre du visa électronique afin de moderniser le traitement des demandes via un système numérique** — Ecomine, 14 October 2026

  DR Congo's foreign minister, Thérèse Kayikwamba Wagner, and digital economy minister, Augustin Kibassa Maliba, met on 14 October 2026 to advance an integrated platform for processing electronic visa applications. No technical details, rollout timetable or access conditions were given.

## Technology

AI · Innovation ecosystem

### AI

CENTRAL BANK POSITION ON ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **André Wameso à Nairobi : Quand la BCC plaide pour une intelligence artificielle au service des Banques centrales africaines** — Magazine RD Congo-Monde, 18 September 2026

  The governor of DR Congo's central bank, André Wameso, told the Central Bank of Kenya's AI conference in Nairobi on 16 September 2026 that the bank plans to use AI in macroeconomic forecasting, banking supervision, payment-system oversight and decision support. He said an internal audit of the national financial system and a consultation of local experts will come before any major deployment.

AVAILABILITY OF ANTHROPIC'S CLAUDE

- **RDC : Claude, l'assistant d'IA d'Anthropic, désormais officiellement accessible** — wearetech.africa, 23 September 2026

  DR Congo's Ministry of Digital Economy announced on 22 September that Anthropic's Claude is now officially available in the country, both the consumer service and commercial API access. Users had previously reached it through VPNs; the communiqué gave no terms.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY

- **Stratégie Nationale de l'Intelligence Artificielle de la République Démocratique du Congo (draft technique) : Faire de l'intelligence artificielle un moteur de progrès technique et de diversification économique, horizon 2030** — Ministère de l'Économie Numérique / Agence pour le Développement du Numérique (ADN), RDC, 6 October 2026

  DR Congo's digital economy ministry has published a technical draft of a national AI strategy to 2030, with 4 pillars and 176 actions. It plans an annual report on AI in the country from 2027 and a minimum of 15% local content in public AI purchases; the text is a draft, not an adopted strategy.

PUBLIC AWARENESS OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **Intelligence artificielle en RDC : la notoriété progresse, les usages s'accélèrent [Target]** — globalnewsrdc, 6 October 2026

  A survey by the DR Congo consultancy Target Sarl of 2,280 adults in the 26 provincial capitals, conducted from 16 to 22 March 2026, found awareness of artificial intelligence rose from 54% in 2025 to 61%, and use from 24% to 47%. Use stands at 54% among men and 41% among women, and ChatGPT is the most used tool.

### Innovation ecosystem

COPA DIGITAL GRANT COMPETITION

- **Entrepreneuriat numérique en RDC : TRANSFORME et le PTN préparent le COPA Digital avec l'appui de la Banque mondiale** — TRANSFORME (UCP), 18 September 2026

  DR Congo's World Bank-financed Digital Transformation Project (PTN) and the TRANSFORME project signed an agreement in Kinshasa on 18 September 2026 to run COPA Digital, a grant competition for digital startups, small firms and incubators, using TRANSFORME's competition platform and procedures. The first cycle is a pilot of about 16 months. Eligibility rules, grant amounts and the opening date have not been published.

KINSHASA TECHNOPARK AND SOVEREIGN DATA CENTRE PROJECT

- **Transformation numérique : Augustin Kibassa Maliba s'inspire du modèle Skolkovo pour le futur Technopark de Kinshasa** — Actu7.cd, 8 October 2026

  The DRC's digital economy minister visited the Skolkovo innovation centre near Moscow as a model for a technology park and sovereign data centre planned for Kinshasa's extension zone. No site, cost or timetable is given.

## Inclusion

Digital divides

### Digital divides

LOW-TECHNOLOGY REMOTE LEARNING IN EBOLA HIGH-RISK AREAS

- **Année scolaire 2026-2027 : Une reprise effective des cours sur toute l'étendue du territoire national malgré les défis sécuritaires et sanitaires** — MINEDU-NC RDC, 3 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of the Congo's education ministry reported that classes resumed on 1 September 2026 in all 60 educational provinces. In 18 sub-divisions classed as high risk for Ebola, the education and health ministries are providing distance learning through worksheets and radio or television broadcasts, designed so families need no internet access or digital equipment.

UNIVERSAL SERVICE FUND PILOT SITES

- **Connectivité : la RDC explore des solutions abordables pour étendre le réseau** — Agence Ecofin, 13 October 2026

  DR Congo's posts and telecommunications ministry is promoting solar-powered microsites to extend mobile coverage to rural and peri-urban areas, presented to the universal service fund and four operators. Fifty pilot sites are planned, each said to cost a quarter of a conventional mast.

## Data

National statistics · Open data

### National statistics

SECOND GENERAL POPULATION AND HOUSING CENSUS

- **Opérations de la cartographie en cours d'opérationnalisation en RDC** — Radio Okapi, 1 September 2026

  The cartography phase of the DRC's second population census is being operationalised with digital tools and satellite imagery, the central census bureau's technical coordinator said — 42 years after the country's only previous census, in 1984.

- **Recensement, identification et enrôlement en RDC : ce qu'il faut savoir** — 7sur7.cd, 1 October 2026

  Two DRC ministers, Patrick Muyaya and Guylain Nyembo, said on 30 September 2026 that the second population and housing census counts people but does not identify them, unlike the separate identification process that is to issue national identity cards. Census mapping began on 28 September; enumeration starts in July 2027, and the operation is costed at US$192m.

### Open data

NATIONAL POLICY ON THE MANAGEMENT AND SECURITY OF ENVIRONMENTAL DATA

- **RDC : alerte sur l'urgence d'élaborer une politique de gestion des données environnementales** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 6 September 2026

  The Congolese Academy of Sciences published a study urging the Democratic Republic of the Congo to adopt a national policy on managing and securing environmental data. It notes that the country had over 125 synoptic weather stations and 400 hydrometric stations in the 1960s, of which few still work, and recommends a national integrated environmental data system modelled on a University of Kinshasa platform.

STATE CONTROL OF GEOLOGICAL DATA

- **Congo extends state control over mining with bid to lock down geological data** — The Citizen, 8 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo is vesting its geological data in the state and charging for access, extending state control over mining; a resource-governance institute questions whether release will be even-handed.

NATIONAL GEOLOGICAL DATA BANK

- **Regulation of the mineral and raw materials sector in the DRC: measures to expand state control and ensure the preservation of geological data** — The Port Brief, 13 September 2026

  DR Congo is building a national bank of geological data on critical minerals through its geological service SGNC, which signed a US$180 million mapping contract with Spain's Xcalibur in January 2026, its director Raoul Wazenga Vitima told Reuters. The bank is due to be fully operational by the end of 2026. Basic data will be free and more sensitive datasets charged for; the fee structure is not given.

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